

The Held Blow

Player-facing description

The Held Blow: In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit.

Public role

Clue / evidence

Handout text

Player-safe note: In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit.

GM truth

Use this element to reveal the cost of managed protection through concrete play.

GM handling

Use when players need a tangible handle on the scene's pressure.

Mechanics

- Title: Discovery / Earn-It Mechanics
- Player Safe: Players can inspect, handle, keep, trade, reveal, or earn The Held Blow when it is present in the fiction.
- Gm Only: Use the roll only when the player's method, stakes, and consequence are concrete.
- No Roll Reveals: Surface read: In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit. Give obvious visible facts freely; roll for meaning, risk, leverage, cost, or a hidden angle.
- Rolls: entity-the-held-blow-engage-the-held-blow entity-the-held-blow Engage The Held Blow Engage The Held Blow Knowledge Finesse Instinct Presence Knowledge Finesse, Instinct, Presence 12 Choose the trait from the player's method, not the entity type. A flat read of The Held Blow hides the cost, motive, or useful next step. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from...
- Fear Spends: Reveal who benefits from the current situation. Make the cost personal

without closing off player agency.

- Condition Options: No official condition unless the item or clue physically creates Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable
- Search Loot: Player-safe note: In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit.

Profile

- Schema Version: clue-profile-v1
- Id: the-held-blow
- Clue Id: the-held-blow
- Clue Name: The Held Blow
- Name: The Held Blow
- Pronunciation: the HELD BLOH
- Clue Kind: behavioral
- Auto Surface: True
- Atlas Lore Note: [Atlas lore - confirm or override]
- Player Safe: The Held Blow In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit. In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit. In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit.
- Block0: the-held-blow The Held Blow the HELD BLOH behavioral
- Block1: they don't actually want to kill; the menace is mostly armor. **HIDDEN** The Bramble Truth the-bramble-truth Complicates victory over the Bramble and rewards empathy, capture, or careful interrogation. <pages/entities/the-held-blow.html>
<pages/clues/the-bramble-truth.html>
- Block2: In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit. they don't actually want to kill; the menace is mostly armor.
- Block3: "did that one just... hold back?" "they're fighting to drive you off, not to kill." You have enough GM-only proof that the Bramble are trying to drive the party off, not simply murder them. You have enough GM-only proof that the Bramble are trying to drive the party off, not simply murder them.
- Block4: The Interrogation Answer Reclaimer Personal Effects the-interrogation-answer reclaimer-personal-effects
- Block5: S02-03 Sablewood? Logistics Preserve Bramble Union Ambusher Instinct 13 to catch it mid-combat; or just narrate it once for an attentive table.
clues/The_Bramble_Truth.md
- Block6: **HIDDEN** Use this clue to support The Bramble Truth: they don't actually want to kill; the menace is mostly armor. whisper True
- Block8: Bright, saturated storybook evidence illustration; clear hero shot of the actual clue object or scene detail; whimsical frontier-Renaissance materials; warm light; bright dystopian corporate satire when branded; no gore, no UI, no watermark, no repeated icon. Depict: a thorn-armored fighter's blade stopping a hair short of a hit. clue wiki card and Player Display evidence visual Send the image and **SHOW** text only. Keep **TELL**, [points_to](#), and blunt ladder rungs GM-only until earned.

/Users/kyle/Documents/My Games/Peril To Profit/story-atlas/src/clue_images/the-held-blow/profile_base.png assets/clue-images/the-held-blow/profile_base.png Bright, saturated storybook evidence illustration; clear hero shot of the actual clue object or scene detail; whimsical frontier-Renaissance materials; warm light; bright dystopian corporate satire when branded; no gore, no UI, no watermark, no repeated icon.

- Block9: Official Daggerheart action roll using Duality Dice, Hope, Fear, and Difficulty; P2P Roll Slider is the table-facing result ladder. Agility move, climb, dodge, reach a better angle, or read evidence while moving Strength lift, hold, force, carry, break, or test weight and pressure Finesse handle, hide, tinker, compare, pick apart, or notice precise detail Instinct perceive, smell, listen, track, read danger, or sense body language Presence charm, soothe, press, lead, deceive, perform, or read a social response Knowledge recall, analyze, investigate, reason from lore, or understand systems Finesse D14 Instinct D14 Presence D14 If the clue is plainly visible, give the SHOW text freely first: In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit. Use the listed Difficulty for the chosen trait. Lower rolls get...
- Mechanicids: duality-dice hope fear difficulty roll-slider clue-discovery
- Visual Assets: profile_base Clue evidence image /Users/kyle/Documents/My Games/Peril To Profit/story-atlas/src/clue_images/the-held-blow/profile_base.png assets/clue-images/the-held-blow/profile_base.png ready The Held Blow clue image. In the fight, a Bramble fighter has a clean opening ? and pulls the strike. A beat of hesitation that doesn't fit a ruthless bandit.

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